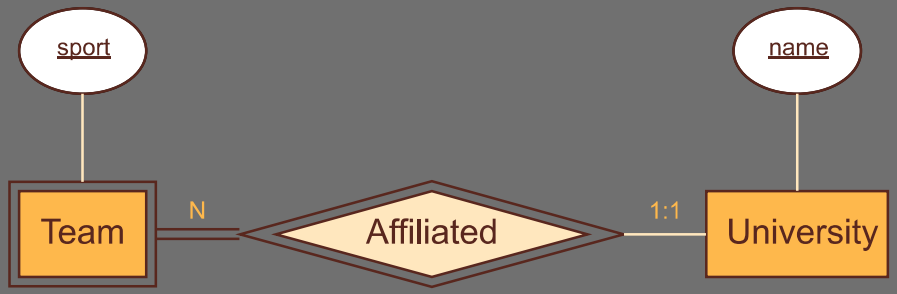
ERD Special Building Blocks

Weak entity set



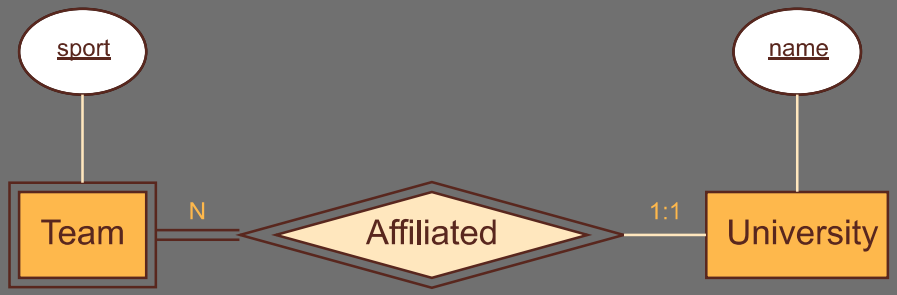
Two requirements:

- Existence/meaning is dependent on another entity set(s).
- Its own attributes aren't sufficient to fully identify it.

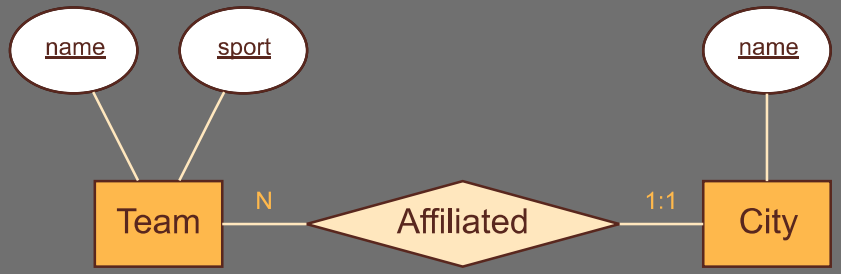
PK = partial key + PKs of identifying entity set(s)

Weak entity set:
a subtle semantic distinction

College:



Professional:



More weak examples

- Dependents depending on an Employee.

- PurchaseLines depending on a Purchase.



CARRABBA'S
ITALIAN GRILL

Orem, UT
(801) 765-1222
0008b Table 31 #Party 6
ALYSSA T SvrCk: 1 11:45a 02/27/15

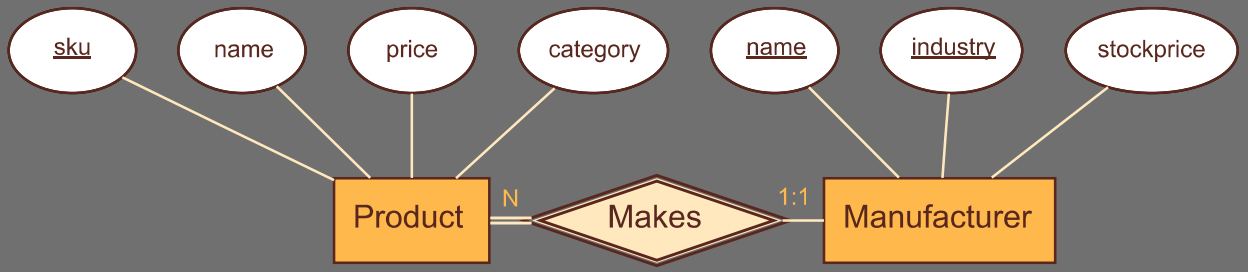
Cold Beverage	2.80
Cold Beverage	2.80
Lunch Small Salmon	12.90
Lunch Salmon	14.50
Lunch Cup Chix Chg/w	2.00
Lunch Fettuccine Carrabba	10.90
Lunch Small Salmon	12.90
Lunch Strawberry Salad	11.50
Lunch Sm Chix Bryan	12.70
Lunch House Salad Add On	2.00
Dessert Rosa	7.20
Dessert Rosa	7.20
Sogno di Cioccolata	7.90
Sogno di Cioccolata	7.90

****

We value your opin'on.
Go to www.TellCarrabbas.com within
the next 3 days and tell us about
your dining experience.

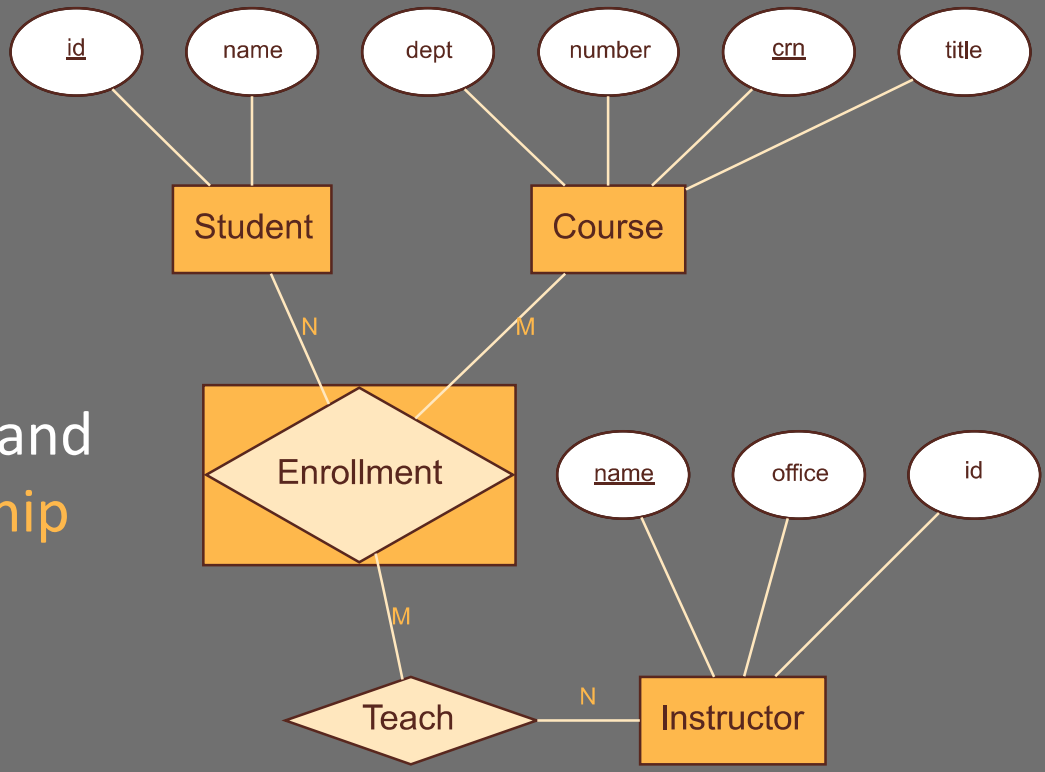
Enter for your chance to win a

Weak non-example

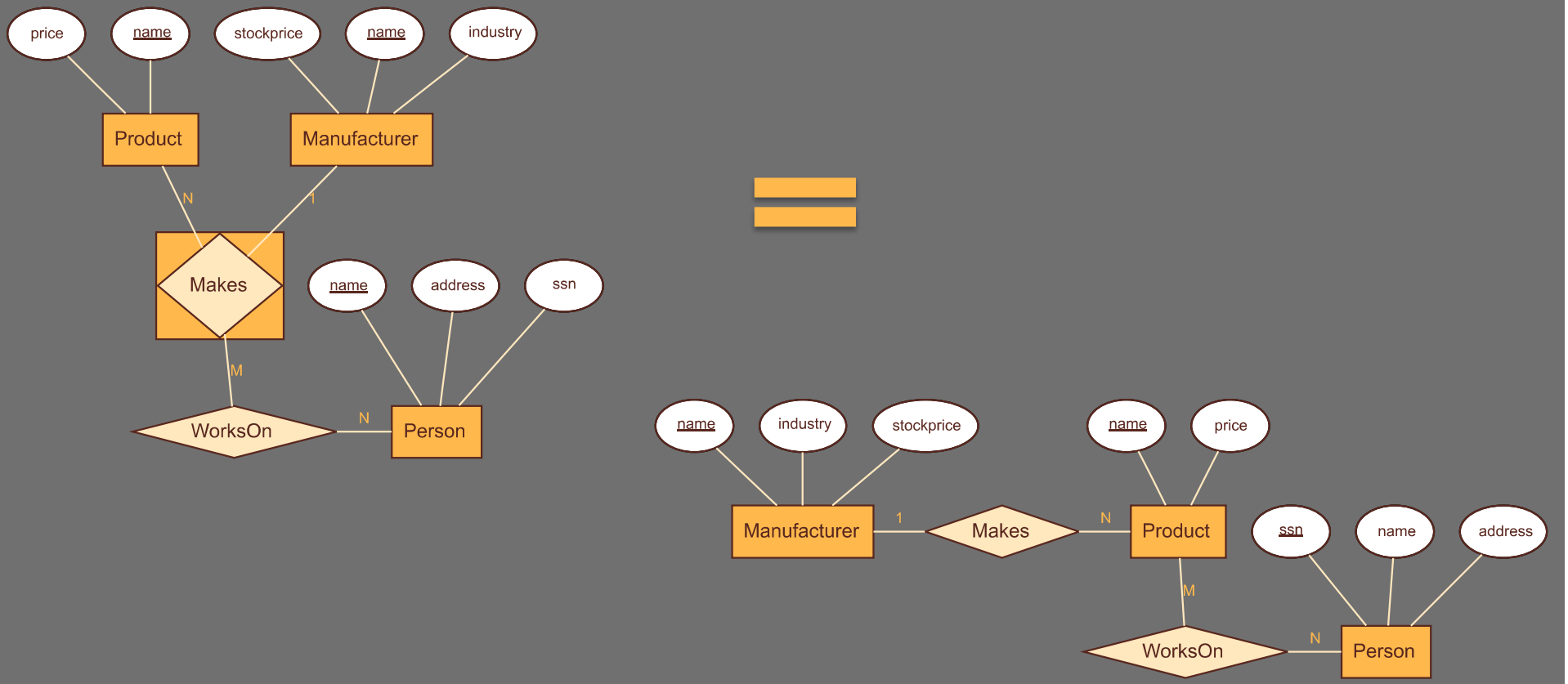


Associative entity set

Entity set and relationship



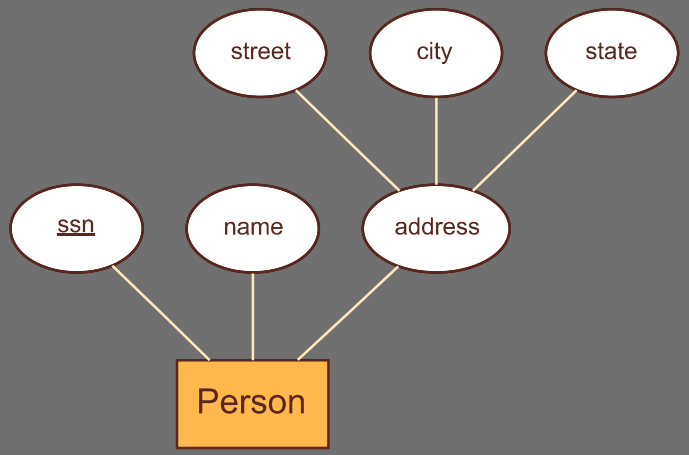
1-many associative not used



Two def'ns of associative entity set

1. All many-many relationships are associative.
   - Motivation: Like entity sets, they are implemented as tables.
2. Relationships that also act as entity sets in another relationship are associative.
   - Corollary: A subset of many-many relationships.
   - Motivation: They act as an entity set in ERD.

Compound attribute



Calculated / Derived attribute

